

Research and the Referral Network

For Matt Campbell, from Chris Habetler. September 29, 2026.

Matt,

On the 22nd you asked what I could do, what it would look like, and what I would charge. This is my best attempt to put some structure around it. Read it as something to react to, and change anything.

The short version: I take research and the day-to-day of the referral network off your desk, so you can open up the five leads you've been holding until October. It starts small and grows as your business grows, which is the shape you described on the call.

What I Would Do

Research: two research packs a month, for ClassE targets or anything else you point me at. Each pack is the crosswalk in the 95 Percent Group format, plus a people map (the 10 to 30 people worth knowing at the company, what they do, and how to reach them) and a short note on the likeliest way in. You get it five business days before your meeting, as a PDF and as a Markdown file for your own AI. This is the "30 people at Canvas" version, where the research comes back with more than you asked for.

The referral network: I'd find and vet new members to fill out the mix in your deck and have the first conversation with each one. You approve and send the contract. Every new member gets a 30-minute onboarding call and a one-page card on each company you're working with, so they know what a good fit looks like. I'd check in with every member monthly, run the monthly meeting with you, and keep one tracker in your Drive. Once a week you get a digest of the intros that are moving, so you can say yes or no in one pass. Members can still come straight to you whenever they want. This covers up to 15 active members.

Client sessions: when you want me in the room as the school-side voice, like Forward Edge on 10/1, one session a month is included.

Month one: prep briefs on your five parked leads, the member list cleaned up, the company cards, and the first weekly digest.

What stays yours: the company relationships, approving intros, contracts, fees, and the final call on positioning. Everything I build lives in your Drive and belongs to you, prompts included.

Pay

\$2,500 a month to start: \$1,500 for research and \$1,000 for the network. It starts on October 1 or the day AAP signs, whichever is later.

The base goes up as you grow. The month you sign a new retainer client at \$5,000 a month or more, it goes to \$3,250. At the next one, it goes to \$4,000. AAP doesn't count, since it's already in the starting number. Each step is paid for by the client that triggers it, and neither of us has to reopen the conversation.

On top of the base, 20% of what EdTech Expertz keeps on network deals that come in after we start. My own intros stay under the agreement we signed in August, so nothing gets paid twice. I don't know what you usually keep on a network deal, and if 20% looks wrong once we see that number, we'll adjust it.

If October is tight, start with research only at \$1,500 and add the network when it makes sense. I would rather cut the scope than the price.

Anything beyond this, I'll price before I start. An extra research pack is \$750, and a prep brief on a prospective client is \$400.

Benchmark is on me. If we've started by then, BrainPOP is the first pack.

A Few More Things

Either of us can end this with 30 days' notice, and you'd get a clean handoff. The network share keeps paying for 12 months on deals already registered.

In January, let's sit down and look at paying clients (three today plus AAP, with a goal of six by March 31), the hours you've gotten back, active members, and intros moving. We reset anything that needs it then.

Items for Conversation

1. A full-time role. I'm in late rounds for a full-time role at a charter network, and there may be others. If one happens, you'll hear it from me first, and I want to keep doing both. What we'd work out together is timing (the network check-ins are the piece most tied to the school day) and anything a school employer would want to clear, since the network puts vendors in front of schools.
2. What you usually keep on a network deal. That number decides whether 20% is right.
3. How many hours a week research and the network take you now.
4. The ClassE advisory you offered to take to Joe. My number for that is \$3,000 a month for up to 15 hours.

Clarity is king, so push on any of it. Happy to talk it through whenever works for you.

Chris